

D354

Talent Acquisition

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A hiring team wants interviews for account managers to better predict job performance. Right now each interviewer asks whatever they like. Interviews take place in a glass-walled conference room, and the vice president likes candidates who played college sports. What change is best?

- A. Let interviewers rely more on their overall gut feeling.
- B. Add more interviewers who each ask their own questions.
- C. Use structured interviews: the same job-related questions for every candidate, scored on anchored scales.
- D. Give extra credit to candidates who played college sports.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A typing test gives candidates almost the same scores when they retake it a week later, but the scores do not predict success in a customer-negotiation role. The test costs \$12 per candidate and takes 10 minutes. What is the problem?

- A. It is valid but not reliable.
- B. It is neither reliable nor valid.
- C. It is reliable but not valid for this job.
- D. It is too cheap and quick to be accurate.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

An HR generalist is preparing a behavioral question for a nursing supervisor role that is posted on three job boards with a \$5,000 sign-on bonus. Which question fits?

- A. What would you do if two nurses argued during a shift?
- B. Do you handle conflict well?
- C. Would the \$5,000 sign-on bonus affect how long you stay?
- D. Tell me about a time you resolved a conflict between two staff members on your shift.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which interview question is situational?

- A.** How many years have you managed suppliers?
- B.** What would you do if a key supplier missed a delivery the day before launch?
- C.** Describe a time a supplier missed a deadline and what you did.
- D.** Where do you see yourself in five years?

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A recruiter needs 6 hires. Historically, 10 percent of applicants are interviewed, 30 percent of those interviewed get offers, and 80 percent of offers are accepted. The job is posted on the careers page, which gets 3,000 visits a month. How many applicants does she need?

- A.** 60
- B.** 25
- C.** 3,000
- D.** 250

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A recruiter has 400 applicants. Fifteen percent are interviewed, 25 percent of those interviewed get offers, and 80 percent of offers are accepted. How many hires should she expect?

- A.** 12
- B.** 60
- C.** 80
- D.** 15

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A company spent \$30,000 on job ads, \$18,000 on agency fees, and \$12,000 on internal recruiter time, and made 15 hires. It also bought a \$9,000 coffee machine for the HR floor. What is its cost per hire?

- A. \$3,200
- B. \$4,000
- C. \$4,600
- D. \$2,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A company targets a cost per hire of \$3,500 for 20 hires. External costs will be \$50,000. What is the most it can spend on internal recruiting costs?

- A. \$120,000
- B. \$20,000
- C. \$1,000
- D. \$70,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

9.

Of 80 men who applied for warehouse associate jobs, 40 were hired. Of 60 women who applied, 18 were hired. The jobs are at a distribution center that opened in March. Is there adverse impact under the four-fifths rule?

- A. Yes; the women's rate is 60 percent of the men's, below 80 percent.
- B. No; the rates differ by exactly 20 points, which is allowed.
- C. No; the men's rate is 167 percent of the women's, which is above 80 percent.
- D. No, because 18 women were hired.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

The group with the highest selection rate is hired at 60 percent. What is the lowest selection rate another group can have without indicating adverse impact under the four-fifths rule?

- A. 75%
- B. 80%
- C. 48%
- D. 40%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A call center loses 35 percent of new hires within 60 days. Exit interviews say the job was much harder than described. The center recently added a game room, and its ads show smiling agents. What is the best fix?

- A. Raise starting pay only.
- B. Expand the game room.
- C. Make the ads even more upbeat.
- D. Add a realistic job preview that shows real call volume, metrics, and hard calls.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A new hire's first day covers benefits forms, a badge photo, and a policy video; after that she is left on her own. The company has a sleek lobby and free parking. Six months later, new-hire retention is low. What is the best improvement?

- A. A structured onboarding plan over the first months with clear goals, a buddy, and manager check-ins.
- B. Treat onboarding as finished once paperwork is done.
- C. Upgrade the lobby and parking.
- D. A longer first-day orientation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A hiring team wants interviews for account managers to better predict job performance. Right now each interviewer asks whatever they like. ~~Interviews take place in a glass-walled conference room, and the vice president likes candidates who played college sports.~~ What change is best?

Target word: best interview change **Decides:** Unstructured questions predict poorly.

A	Inverted operation	Moves further from structure.
B	Adjacent category	More unstructured interviews do not add structure.
C	Correct	Structure improves prediction and fairness.
D	Camouflage	The VP's preference is not job-related.

2. Answer C Concept 2

A typing test gives candidates almost the same scores when they retake it a week later, but the scores do not predict success in a customer-negotiation role. ~~The test costs \$12 per candidate and takes 10 minutes.~~ What is the problem?

Target word: diagnose the test **Decides:** Consistent scores that do not predict performance.

A	Inverted operation	Reverses the two properties.
B	Confusion set	Retest scores are consistent, so it is reliable.
C	Correct	Consistent, but it does not measure what predicts success.
D	Camouflage	Cost and length do not decide validity.

3. Answer D Concept 3

An HR generalist is preparing a behavioral question for a nursing supervisor role ~~that is posted on three job boards with a \$5,000 sign-on bonus.~~ Which question fits?

Target word: behavioral question **Decides:** Asks about past behavior.

A	Confusion set	Hypothetical: situational.
B	Adjacent category	Yes-or-no self-rating, not behavior.
C	Camouflage	About the bonus, not past behavior.
D	Correct	Asks for a real past example.

4. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

Which interview question is situational?

Target word: situational question — reverse **Decides:** Hypothetical future case.

A	Adjacent category	An experience question.
B	Correct	Asks what the candidate would do.
C	Inverted operation	Past behavior: behavioral.
D	Confusion set	A career-goals question, not a job scenario.

5. Answer D Concept 4

A recruiter needs 6 hires. Historically, 10 percent of applicants are interviewed, 30 percent of those interviewed get offers, and 80 percent of offers are accepted. The job is posted on the careers page, which gets 3,000 visits a month. How many applicants does she need?

Target word: applicants needed **Decides:** $6 \div (0.10 \times 0.30 \times 0.80) = 6 \div 0.024$.

A	Dropped element	$6 \div 0.10$ drops the offer and acceptance stages.
B	Adjacent category	That is interviews needed ($6 \div 0.24$), not applicants.
C	Wrong stem number	Page visits, not an applicant target.
D	Correct	$6 \div 0.024 = 250$.

6. Answer A Concept 4 • transfer

A recruiter has 400 applicants. Fifteen percent are interviewed, 25 percent of those interviewed get offers, and 80 percent of offers are accepted. How many hires should she expect?

Target word: solve forward for hires **Decides:** $400 \times 0.15 \times 0.25 \times 0.80$.

A	Correct	$400 \rightarrow 60 \rightarrow 15 \rightarrow 12$.
B	Adjacent category	Interviews, not hires.
C	Wrong stem number	The acceptance percentage.
D	Dropped element	Stops at offers.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A company spent \$30,000 on job ads, \$18,000 on agency fees, and \$12,000 on internal recruiter time, and made 15 hires. It also bought a \$9,000 coffee machine for the HR floor. What is its cost per hire?

Target word: cost per hire **Decides:** $(\$30,000 + \$18,000 + \$12,000) \div 15$.

A	Dropped element	$\$48,000 \div 15$ leaves out internal costs.
B	Correct	$\$60,000 \div 15 = \$4,000$.
C	Camouflage	Adds the unrelated coffee machine.
D	Wrong stem number	Uses only ad spending.

8. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

A company targets a cost per hire of \$3,500 for 20 hires. External costs will be \$50,000. What is the most it can spend on internal recruiting costs?

Target word: solve for internal budget **Decides:** Total allowed = $\$3,500 \times 20 = \$70,000$.

A	Inverted operation	Adds external costs instead of subtracting.
B	Correct	$\$70,000 - \$50,000 = \$20,000$.
C	Adjacent category	Internal cost per hire, not the total.
D	Dropped element	Total budget, not the internal share.

9. Answer A Concept 6

Of 80 men who applied for warehouse associate jobs, 40 were hired. Of 60 women who applied, 18 were hired. The jobs are ~~at a distribution center that opened in March~~. Is there adverse impact under the four-fifths rule?

Target word: adverse impact test **Decides:** $30\% \div 50\% = 0.60$.

A	Correct	$18/60 = 30\%$; $40/80 = 50\%$; $30 \div 50 = 0.60$.
B	Confusion set	The rule is a ratio, not a 20-point gap.
C	Inverted operation	Flips the ratio.
D	Dropped element	Counts hires instead of comparing rates.

10. Answer C Concept 6 • transfer

The group with the highest selection rate is hired at 60 percent. What is the lowest selection rate another group can have without indicating adverse impact under the four-fifths rule?

Target word: solve for threshold rate **Decides:** $0.80 \times 60\%$.

A	Inverted operation	$60 \div 0.80$ divides instead of multiplying.
B	Wrong stem number	The rule's ratio, not a selection rate.
C	Correct	$0.80 \times 60\% = 48\%$.
D	Confusion set	Subtracts 20 points instead of taking 80 percent.

11. Answer D Concept 7

A call center loses 35 percent of new hires within 60 days. Exit interviews say the job was much harder than described. ~~The center recently added a game room~~, and its ads show smiling agents. What is the best fix?

Target word: fix early turnover **Decides:** Expectations were set wrong.

A	Adjacent category	Pay does not fix the mismatch in expectations.
B	Camouflage	Perks do not address the cause.
C	Inverted operation	Widens the expectation gap.
D	Correct	Accurate expectations reduce early quits.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A new hire's first day covers benefits forms, a badge photo, and a policy video; after that she is left on her own. ~~The company has a sleek lobby and free parking~~. Six months later, new-hire retention is low. What is the best improvement?

Target word: best improvement **Decides:** Only orientation, no ongoing onboarding.

A	Correct	Ongoing onboarding drives retention.
B	Dropped element	Drops everything after day one.
C	Camouflage	Facilities do not decide retention here.
D	Adjacent category	Still a one-time event.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	4	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	0	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Structured interviews	Asking every candidate the same job-related questions and scoring with anchored scales predicts performance better than unstructured interviews.	Trusting gut feel or shared interests.	“Improve prediction” or “reduce bias” in interviewing.
2	Reliability vs. validity	Reliability means consistent scores; validity means scores predict or measure what matters for the job. A test can be reliable without being valid.	Assuming a consistent test is a good predictor.	Stable scores that do not predict job success.
3	Behavioral vs. situational questions	Behavioral questions ask what the candidate did in the past; situational questions ask what they would do in a hypothetical case.	Calling any scenario question behavioral.	“Tell me about a time...” vs. “What would you do if...”
4	Recruiting yield ratios	Applicants needed = hires ÷ (product of the stage pass-through rates).	Stopping at one stage or multiplying where you should divide.	A hiring target and percentages for each stage.
5	Cost per hire	Cost per hire = (external + internal recruiting costs) ÷ number of hires.	Leaving out internal costs or adding unrelated spending.	A list of costs and a hire count.
6	Four-fifths rule	Adverse impact is indicated when a group’s selection rate is less than 80 percent of the highest group’s rate.	Treating it as a 20-point gap or comparing raw counts.	Selection rates for two groups.
7	Realistic job preview	Showing both the good and hard parts of a job lowers early turnover by setting accurate expectations.	Making ads more upbeat or adding perks to fix early quits.	New hires leave quickly saying the job was not as described.
8	Onboarding vs. orientation	Orientation is first-day paperwork and logistics; onboarding is a months-long process with goals, a buddy or mentor, and manager check-ins that drives retention.	Thinking a longer first day is onboarding.	New hires left alone after day one.

Course scope (public description): Talent acquisition is about building the workforce that drives organizational success. This course equips you with strategies for planning, recruiting, selecting, and onboarding employees. You will learn how to identify skill gaps, attract top candidates, and make selection decisions that balance technical ability with cultural fit. These skills are essential in HR careers where securing the right talent is one of the most important contributions to organizational growth.